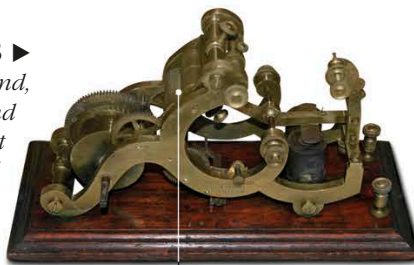


MODERN COMMUNICATIONS ►

In the Civil War, railroads moved troops around, aerial balloons spied across enemy lines, and the telegraph (right) sent and received instant information. Its receiver machine recorded messages on paper tape in Morse code, which uses dots and dashes to represent numbers and letters of the alphabet.



The paper tape came out of here marked with Morse code.

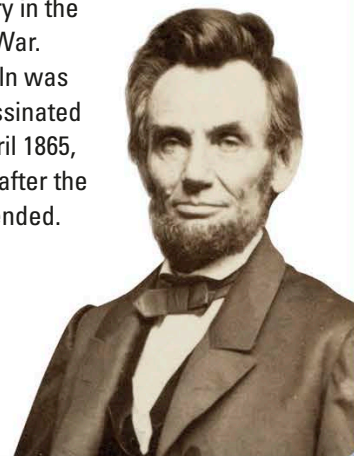


◀ A CONTINENTAL WAR

Most of the fighting in the war took place in Virginia, Maryland, and Pennsylvania in the east. There were also battles in Kentucky and Tennessee in the west and down the Mississippi River to New Orleans. In 1864, General William T. Sherman (left) conducted a major campaign in Georgia and the Carolinas.

ABRAHAM LINCOLN

Born into rural poverty in Kentucky, Abraham Lincoln (1809–1865), trained as a lawyer. He was elected president in 1861 and his strong leadership steered the Union to victory in the Civil War. Lincoln was assassinated in April 1865, days after the war ended.



1750–1900

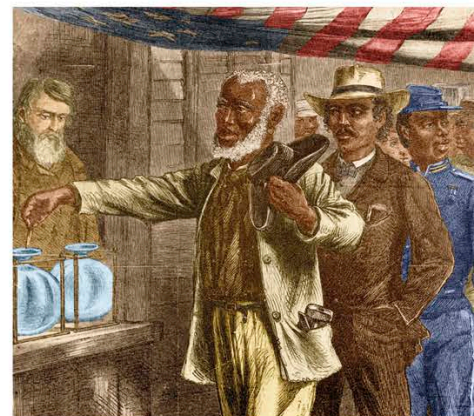


▲ THE ABOLITION OF SLAVERY

On September 22, 1862, President Lincoln issued the Emancipation Proclamation, which freed all enslaved people in the Confederacy from January 1, 1863. In 1865 Congress passed the 13th Amendment (law change) to the US Constitution, making slavery illegal across the soon-to-be reunited country.

▼ RECONSTRUCTION

A process of rebuilding and reconstruction followed the war. In 1870, the US Constitution was amended to allow Black men the right to vote. When Reconstruction ended in 1877, southern states introduced laws that legalized discrimination against Black people. They remained in place for almost a century.



1863

The 54th Massachusetts Infantry Regiment—the first Black regiment in US history—is formed in Boston.

1863

Union forces win the Battle of Gettysburg in Pennsylvania, turning the tide of war in their favor. It is the bloodiest battle of the war.

1864

General Sherman leads the “March to the Sea” through Georgia, destroying railroads and towns in an attempt to damage the Confederate economy.

1865

Confederate forces under General Robert E. Lee surrender at Appomattox Court House in Virginia, ending the war.